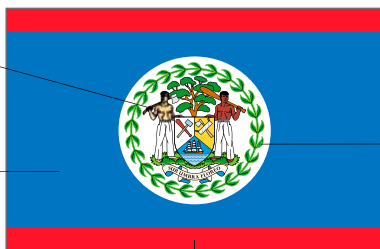


Belize

Ratio: 3:5 **Adopted:** September 21, 1981 **Usage:** National and Civil

The coat of arms was granted in 1907

Blue is the party color of the PUP



The 50 leaves recall 1950, the year the PUP came to power

Red stripes were added to denote the color of the opposition party

North America



Belize was originally known as British Honduras, a colony formed in 1862 from settlements on the coast of Guatemala.

British Honduras obtained a coat of arms on January 28, 1907, which formed the basis of the badge used on British ensigns. The coat of arms recalls the logging industry which first led to British settlement there.

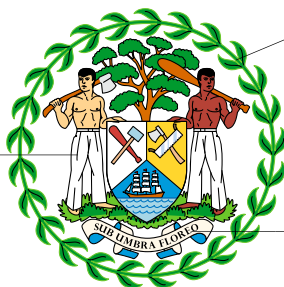
From 1968 onward an unofficial national flag was in use. It was blue with a modified version of the arms

—minus the Union Jack—on a white disc in the center. The colors were those of the People's United Party (PUP). Around the arms was a wreath of 50 leaves, recalling 1950, when the PUP came to prominence.

On independence in 1981, the flag was retained but red was added to stand for the opposition party.

ARMS OF BELIZE

The figures, tools, and the mahogany tree represent the logging industry



Wreath of 50 leaves

National motto—"Sub Umbra Floreo" meaning "I Flourish in the Shade"